Cornell Bowers CIS College of Computing and Information Science

CORNELL FUTURE OF LEARNING LAB

INFO 1170/5170: AI in Organizations

Lecture (75 minutes)

Tuesday	11:40PM – 12:55 PM	Upson 142

Discussion Sections (75 minutes)

201	Thursday	1:25PM – 2:40PM	Hollister Hall 306
202	Thursday	2:55PM – 4:10PM	Statler Hall 441

Office Hours

Prof	Friday	2:00PM – 3:00PM	CIS 363 / Zoom
UG TA	Wednesday	12:00 PM - 1:00 PM	CIS 360A / Zoom
GR TA	Friday	4:30PM – 5:30 PM	CIS 360A / Zoom

Teaching Team

Dr. René Kizilcec (Associate Professor of Information Science; kizilcec@cornell.edu)
Jadon Geathers (PhD Student in Information Science; jag569@cornell.edu)
Sneha Singhi (UG Senior in Information Science/Psychology; ss3298@cornell.edu)

Course Materials (Readings, Activities) and AI Course Assistant

https://app.hita.ai/courses/e94711ba-7f11-43b2-a5fa-29a5163ab4a5/outline

Assignment submissions, Grades, EdDiscussion

https://canvas.cornell.edu/courses/81618

Course Description

Artificial intelligence (AI) is impacting how organizations operate, make decisions, and deliver value across various sectors, including education, law, creative industries, insurance, and information technology. This course introduces the concepts, frameworks, and real-world applications needed to critically analyze how AI is adopted in organizations and the effects it has on work, learning, well-being, and society. Students will explore both the opportunities and risks of AI, including issues of bias, privacy, and organizational responsibility. Weekly hands-on activities and discussions

will give students experience auditing or prototyping AI tools using no-code or low-code platforms, and case studies will bring sector-specific challenges to life. A culminating project allows students to investigate AI in a domain of their choice and present their insights in a university-wide showcase.

Learning Objectives

1. Explain core concepts, applications, and limitations of AI in organizational contexts.
2. Critically analyze the benefits, risks, and ethical considerations of AI adoption across sectors.
3. Apply interdisciplinary frameworks to assess AI's impact on work, learning, well-being, and society.
4. Prototype and audit AI-driven tools (using no-code/low-code environments) contextualized to specific organizations or industries.
5. Communicate technical and societal implications of AI effectively to varied audiences.

Prerequisites

The course has no prerequisites. Everyone is welcome.

Course Structure and Grading

Each week, you will have one lecture meeting and one TA-led discussion section. The course covers several organizational contexts and the uses and impacts of AI within them. Weekly activities include assigned readings, reading elaborations, case discussions, and homework. There is a final project and an open project showcase event, but no midterm or final exam.

HITA as the Learning Platform: All readings, discussion prompts, and assignments are released on HITA. HITA hosts the AI-assisted reading elaboration activities, which are designed to help you reflect critically on each week's readings and prepare for discussion. **You are permitted and encouraged to use HITA** to support your learning and understanding (instead of other AI tools), because it is tailored for this course and its goals. Questions students ask on HITA are visible to teaching staff only anonymously (no names are associated with questions), except for graded activities like reading elaborations.

Overall Grade Breakdown: Students enrolled in the **5000-level version** of the course will complete additional graded course work as described below.

- Lecture and Section Attendance: 10%
- Readings and Reading Elaboration Activities (HITA): 20%
- Homework Assignments: 35%
- Final Group Project and Showcase: 35%
    - Proposal (5%)
    - Mid-semester Check-in (5%)
    - Final Showcase (10%)
    - Final Report (15%)

Lecture and Section Attendance (10%): Active participation in both lectures and discussion sections is expected and accounts for 10% of the final grade. Discussion sections use the case method to explore real-world examples of AI in organizations, so preparation and attendance are critical.

Readings and Reading Elaboration Activities (20%): Most weeks, students will complete assigned readings (academic articles, reports, and cases). A reading elaboration activity on HITA prompts students to summarize key points, raise critical questions, and engage with the material. Completion and thoughtful engagement are required for full credit.

Homework Assignments (35%): Homework consists of hands-on assignments such as prototyping a no-code AI workflow, auditing an AI system, or analyzing a short case scenario, and reporting on what you've learned in the process. These assignments help you practice critical evaluation and develop technical skills that support the final project.

Final Group Project and Showcase (35%): The final group project is a team-based investigation of AI in a domain of your choice. Your team may either:

a. Prototype a simple AI tool using no-code/low-code platforms (e.g., chatbot, content generator, risk calculator), or
b. Audit an existing AI application in an organization, evaluating its technical design, adoption process, and societal impacts, or
c. Complete another type of project approved by the teaching team.

Students will be evaluated on:

- **Project Proposal (Week 4)**: Teams submit a 2- to 3-page proposal describing their domain of interest, research questions, and planned project.

- **Mid-semester Check-in (Week 8)**: Teams present 5-minute progress updates to their discussion section, receiving peer and instructor feedback.
- **Final Showcase (Week 15)**: Teams present their artifact (prototype/audit/other) and a critical analysis of its organizational and societal implications in a public showcase with invited industry guests.
- **Final Report (Week 15)**: Teams write a final report (between 3-5k words) detailing their project findings.

Team projects will also include brief peer evaluations (ungraded and anonymous) focusing on contribution and collaboration.

Individual and Group Work: Students will work individually on readings and reading elaborations, conducted through HiTA. Some homework assignments will be completed individually, while others will be conducted in teams to prepare for collaborative final projects. Teamwork is expected to be collaborative and professional, with a clear division of responsibilities and tasks. All individual submissions must reflect your own work. Code, text, or analysis from other students cannot be copied (see Academic Integrity).

Group work is a necessary part of learning to work collaboratively. We will use an individual feedback survey where group members rate their ability to work collaboratively. This gives members a chance to quietly express any concerns about other members contributing equally and also disincentives students to overdepend one particular member.

Late Work Policy: We understand that life can be unpredictable. This course is designed to support your learning and well-being, and we value fairness for all students.

If you are ill or have an approved reason (e.g., a job interview, academic trips, athletics) for missing any deadline, please fill out this form to register your excuse ahead of time. A member of the teaching team will review your submission and send a confirmation or request for more information. Below are our guidelines for late or missed work:

Lecture & Section Attendance: Attendance is expected unless you are ill or have an approved reason (e.g., a job interview, academic trips, athletics).

Readings and Reading Elaboration Activities: Readings are assigned weekly for the class and involve completing an elaboration activity on HITA, typically due Monday at 11:59PM. You have a **24-hour grace period** after the deadline to submit your work. After

this period, no credit will be given. Elaboration activities are **graded for completion**, but must reflect thoughtful engagement.

Homework Assignments: Homework assignments are typically due Monday at 11:59PM. You have a **24-hour grace period** after the deadline to submit your work. After the grace period, **25% of the total score will be deducted per additional day late** (automatically applied on Canvas), such that an assignment is scored as 0% after 4 days.

Final Project Components: All components of the final project must be submitted on time. The final project showcase must be prepared on time so your team can fully participate, without exceptions.

If you're facing a personal, health, or accessibility challenge, please reach out early. We're here to support you, and reasonable extensions will be granted when requested in advance.

How to Get Help: Students can get help in several ways. You can always talk to members of the teaching team after class and join office hours (see times/locations above). You can also ask questions in **EdDiscussion**; the teaching team monitors that channel and classmates may also be able to help out. Questions asked on EdDiscussion late in the evening are likely not going to be answered until the next day. To help you 24/7 with any questions, we implemented the HITA AI course assistant, which is aware of all course materials and assignments. As a last resort, you can also email the teaching team, but this will yield the slowest response time.

Academic Integrity: Academic honesty is a serious matter and will be treated as such. Academic dishonesty harms trust within our community and penalties can therefore be severe. Each student in this course is expected to abide by the Cornell University Code of Academic Integrity at all times. Any work submitted by a student in this course for academic credit must be that student's own work. For group work, all team members should contribute meaningfully and be able to explain any part of the submission. All outside assistance should be noted and the work of others should be properly cited. For more information, check out Cornell's academic integrity resources. If you have questions about what constitutes academic dishonesty, you can always reach out to the instructor and teaching team on Slack. **You are free to use the HITA tool to get help in this course.** GenAI tools can be useful for getting help in many ways. What matters most is that you use these tools in combination with your critical thinking skills. Don't

simply accept the answer–probe it, question it, ask for more explanation if it is still unclear.

Accommodations and Counseling Resources: Let me know as soon as possible if you require special accommodations due to learning disabilities, religious practices, physical requirements, medical needs, etc. We are committed to creating an inclusive learning environment for all students. It is not uncommon for students to experience stressful events at some point during college. Students sometimes experience anxiety, depression, financial strain, the loss of loved ones, family stress, and other stressors. It is perfectly normal for students to seek the service of mental health professionals to provide them with support and skills to cope with these experiences. Cornell Health is offering a variety of services to students on and off campus: https://health.cornell.edu/services/mental-health-care. You can also call Cornell Health at (607) 255-5155.

Class Topics Overview (subject to changes)

Week	Topic
1	Intro to AI and Organizations
2	Foundations of AI
3	Theoretical Lenses
4	Ethics, Bias, and Fairness
5	Education Part 1
6	Education Part 2
7	Information Technology & Software Engineering
8	Creative Industries
9	Law
10	Business & Consulting
11	Healthcare
12	Insurance
13	Other Sectors
14	Societal Impacts
15	Project Showcase